PLACE Making Team Aboriculture

Development Management Consultation Response

Date: 03 June 2024

Reference:	Site:	Proposal:	Case Officer:
S/COND/22/0315	Land North Of A420 Eastern Villages Swindon	Discharge of condition 9 (Character Area Design Code) from Outline Planning Permission S/OUT/13/1555	Ed Snook
Summary of response			
		No Comment/No Objection	☐
		Conditions required	☐
		Objection - changes required	☒
		Objection in principle	☐
Executive Summary			

Full Comments

Much of the arboricultural guidance within the Character Area Design Code for Marston Gate and Nightingale Corner (Taylor Wimpey/Vistry Group May 2024) is via direct reference to the Tree Strategy included in the South Marston Expansion and Rowborough Village Strategic Design Code (March 2024). The tree strategy is given some useful context within the Built Form and Identity section (Section 5) as a component of the Overarching Landscape Design (p42). The In-parcel Tree Strategy (p43) is an almost direct extract from the strategic design code, albeit with a suite of new (and expanded) suggested tree species.

I acknowledge the value of maintaining the prominence of the site-wide tree strategy and have no particular issues in broadening the examples of suitable species, other than the use of Pyrus calleryana Chanticleer as an inclusion for both Type 1 and Type 2 options. It should not be regarded as a focal tree and should be substituted in Type 1 by a more appropriate species. I note, also, that there are two or three heavily fruiting species that may create a conflict if they are situated adjacent to hard surfaces.

The use of trees within the street typologies set out in the Access and Movement section (Section 4) replicates what has been considered and agreed for the strategic design code. There is a significant part of the original tree strategy that indicates how the growing environment for new trees is expected to be safeguarded and this should be signposted in the character area design code.

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The Character Area Vision diagram (p21) identifies two Landscape Gateways which are referred to throughout the document, yet the Character Area Design Code is short on guidance as to how the design of these landscape-led gateways will instill the character. The three-dimensional illustration (untitled) on page 53 notates each position as 'enhanced landscape design' but without referencing any guidance on the design.